MATHEMATICAL FORMULAE

1 Vector Algebra

$$\mathbf{a} = a_1\mathbf{i} + a_2\mathbf{j} + a_3\mathbf{k} \;=\; (a_1, a_2, a_3)$$

Scalar(Dot) Product $\quad \mathbf{a}\cdot\mathbf{b} = a_1b_1 + a_2b_2 + a_3b_3$

Vector (Cross) Product

$$\mathbf{a}\times\mathbf{b} = \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ a_1 & a_2 & a_3 \\ b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \end{vmatrix} = (a_2b_3 - a_3b_2)\mathbf{i} + (a_3b_1 - a_1b_3)\mathbf{j} + (a_1b_2 - a_2b_1)\mathbf{k}.$$

Triple vector product $\quad \mathbf{a}\times(\mathbf{b}\times\mathbf{c}) = (\mathbf{a}\cdot\mathbf{c})\mathbf{b} - (\mathbf{a}\cdot\mathbf{b})\mathbf{c}$

Triple scalar product

$$\mathbf{a}\cdot(\mathbf{b}\times\mathbf{c}) = \mathbf{b}\cdot(\mathbf{c}\times\mathbf{a}) = \begin{vmatrix} a_1 & a_2 & a_3 \\ b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \\ c_1 & c_2 & c_3 \end{vmatrix} = a_1b_2c_3 + a_2b_3c_1 + a_3b_1c_2 - a_1b_3c_2 - a_2b_1c_3 - a_3b_2c_1$$

2 Series

$$(1+x)^n = 1+nx+\frac{n(n-1)}{2!}x^2+\frac{n(n-1)(n-2)}{3!}x^3+\ldots+\frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\cdots(n-r+1)}{r!}x^r+\ldots \;(n\,\text{arbitrary}\,, |x|<1)$$

$$e^x = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \ldots + \frac{x^r}{r!} + \ldots \qquad \text{for all } x$$

$$\ln(1+x) = x - \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{3} - \ldots + (-1)^{r+1}\frac{x^r}{r} + \ldots \qquad \text{for } -1 < x \leq 1$$

$$\cos x = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^4}{4!} - \ldots + \frac{(-1)^r x^{2r}}{(2r)!} + \ldots \qquad \text{for all } x$$

$$\sin x = x - \frac{x^3}{3!} + \frac{x^5}{5!} - \ldots + \frac{(-1)^r x^{2r+1}}{(2r+1)!} + \ldots \qquad \text{for all } x$$

3 Trigonometric Identities and Hyperbolic Functions

$$\sin(A+B) = \sin A\cos B + \sin B\cos A\,, \qquad \cos(A+B) = \cos A\cos B - \sin A\sin B$$

$$\cos(iz) = \cosh z\,, \quad \cosh(iz) = \cos z\,, \quad \sin(iz) = i\,\sinh(z)\,, \quad \sinh(iz) = i\,\sin z$$

$$e^{ix} = \cos(x) + i\sin(x)$$

$$\cos(x)\cos(y) = \frac{1}{2}\cos(x-y) + \frac{1}{2}\cos(x+y)$$

$$a\cos x + b\sin(x) = c\cos(x+\theta) \quad \text{where} \quad c = \sqrt{a^2+b^2} \quad \text{and} \quad \theta = \tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{b}{a}\right)$$

4 Differential Calculus

1. Leibnitz' Formula: $D^n(fg) =$

$$D^n f\, g + \binom{n}{1} D^{n-1} f\, Dg + \binom{n}{2} D^{n-2} f\, D^2 g + \cdots + \binom{n}{r} D^{n-r} f\, D^r g + \cdots + f D^n g$$

where $\left(\begin{array}{c} n \\ r \end{array} \right) = \dfrac{n(n-1)(n-2)\cdots(n-r+1)}{r!}$.

2. Taylor expansion of $f(x)$ about the point $x = a$

$$f(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x-a)^2 + \frac{f'''(a)}{3!}(x-a)^3 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x-a)^n + R_n(x)$$

where

$$R_n(x) = \frac{(x-a)^{n+1}}{(n+1)!} f^{(n+1)}(c), \qquad a < c < x$$

Putting $x = a + h$ gives the form

$$f(a+h) = f(a) + hf'(a) + \frac{h^2}{2!} f''(a) + \frac{h^3}{3!} f'''(a) + \ldots$$

3. Taylor expansion of $f(x, y)$ about the point (a, b):

$$f(x,y) = f(a,b) + \frac{1}{1!}\left[(x-a)\frac{\partial}{\partial x} + (y-b)\frac{\partial}{\partial y}\right] f(a,b) + \frac{1}{2!}\left[(x-a)\frac{\partial}{\partial x} + (y-b)\frac{\partial}{\partial y}\right]^2 f(a,b) + \cdots$$

4. Chain rule for partial derivatives: $f = f(x, y)$

(i) If $x = x(t)$ and $y = y(t)$ then $f = F(t)$ and

$$\frac{dF}{dt} = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}\frac{dx}{dt} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}\frac{dy}{dt}$$

(ii) If x and y are expressed in terms of new variables u and v by $x(u, v)$ and $y(u, v)$ then $f = F(u, v)$ and

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial u} = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}\,\frac{\partial x}{\partial u} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}\,\frac{\partial y}{\partial u}, \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{\partial F}{\partial v} = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}\,\frac{\partial x}{\partial v} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}\,\frac{\partial y}{\partial v}$$

(iii) If $y = y(x)$ then $f = F(x)$ and

$$\frac{dF}{dx} = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}\frac{dy}{dx}$$

5. Stationary points of $f(x, y)$ occur where $f_x = 0$ and $f_y = 0$. Let (a, b) be a stationary point, and consider $D = f_{xx}(a, b)f_{yy}(a, b) - [f_{xy}(a, b)]^2$. Then

(a) If $D > 0$ and $f_{xx}(a, b) < 0$, then (a, b) is a maximum;

(b) If $D > 0$ and $f_{xx}(a, b) > 0$, then (a, b) is a minimum;

(c) If $D < 0$ then (a, b) is a saddle point;

(d) if $D = 0$, more information is required.

6. Differential Equations

(i) The first order linear equation $\dfrac{dy}{dx} + p(x)y = r(x)$ has an integrating factor $I(x) = \exp\left\{\displaystyle\int p(x)\, dx\right\}$ which allows one to write the DE in the form $\dfrac{d}{dx}(I(x)y) = I(x)r(x)$.

(ii) The first-order equation $P(x, y)\dfrac{dy}{dx} + Q(x, y) = 0$ is exact if $\dfrac{\partial P}{\partial x} = \dfrac{\partial Q}{\partial y}$.

5 Integral Calculus

1. An important substitution: $\tan(\theta/2) = t$; then

$$\sin\theta = \frac{2t}{1+t^2}\,, \quad \cos\theta = \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2}\,, \quad d\theta = \frac{2\ dt}{1+t^2}\,.$$

2.

$$\int \frac{dx}{(a^2-x^2)^{1/2}} \;=\; \sin^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right)\,, \quad |x| < a\,.$$

3.

$$\int \frac{dx}{(a^2+x^2)^{1/2}} \;=\; \sinh^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right) \;=\; \ln\left[\frac{x}{a} + \left(\frac{x^2}{a^2}+1\right)^{1/2}\right]\,.$$

4.

$$\int \frac{dx}{(x^2-a^2)^{1/2}} \;=\; \cosh^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right) \;=\; \ln\left[\frac{x}{a} + \left(\frac{x^2}{a^2}-1\right)^{1/2}\right]\,.$$

5.

$$\int \frac{dx}{a^2+x^2} \;=\; \left(\frac{1}{a}\right)\tan^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{a}\right)\,.$$